

August 26, 2025

CPUC Energy Division Tariff Unit
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RE: Response of the Vehicle Grid Integration Council to Pacific Gas and Electric Advice Letter 7378-E-A Supplemental: PG&E's Request for Modification to Phase II Scope for PG&E's Vehicle-to-Everything Pilot #3 (V2X Microgrid Pilot)

Dear Sir or Madam:

Pursuant to the provisions of General Order 96-B, the Vehicle Grid Integration Council ("VGIC") hereby submits this response to the above-referenced Advice Letter 7378-E-A of Pacific Gas and Electric Company ("PG&E"), *Supplemental: PG&E's Request for Modification to Phase II Scope for PG&E's Vehicle-to-Everything Pilot #3 (V2X Microgrid Pilot)* ("Advice Letter") on August 6, 2025.

VGIC appreciates PG&E's work to advance vehicle-grid integration ("VGI") in its service territory by conducting three VGI pilots and providing learnings on how to best integrate electric vehicles ("EVs") into the grid and leverage bidirectional charging capabilities. The V2X Microgrid Pilot discussed in this Advice Letter has yielded valuable learnings but has also seen challenges. Given this, PG&E is requesting that Phase II of the microgrid pilot transition into a hybrid support model where PG&E staff continues supporting V2X readiness in a technical consultancy role at Microgrid Incentive Program sites.

Generally, VGIC supports PG&E's request to transition away from the original Phase II scope. However, VGIC recommends the V2X Microgrid Pilot resources be redirected to provide additional funding and staff support for the other two V2X Pilots: Residential and Commercial. Moreover, VGIC believes that it is inappropriate for PG&E to publicly disclose specific details on vendors included in Appendix I of the Advice Letter. The Commission should remind PG&E and other utilities to file sensitive information confidentially.

I. VGIC SUPPORTS PG&E'S TRANSITION AWAY FROM THE PHASE II V2X MICROGRID PILOT.

It has long been acknowledged, and discussed previously in VGIC filings, that the V2X Microgrid Pilot includes the most complex projects of the three VGI pilots approved in Resolution

E-5192. While PG&E's VGI pilots are testing deployment strategies for new bidirectional charging solutions, including developing customer engagement strategies and modernizing utility operations and planning, community microgrids are themselves still in a pilot stage and often utilize nascent equipment and configurations. This has created unique challenges for the V2X Microgrid Pilot.

In response to these challenges, PG&E is requesting to transition the Phase II pilot to a hybrid support model. This will allow customers participating in the Microgrid Incentive Program (MIP) to leverage bidirectional technologies in their community microgrids. VGIC believes that directing efforts to MIP to integrate bidirectional EVs into community microgrids is reasonable, given that it is expected that communities building these microgrids will be participating in MIP. PG&E does not need to duplicate efforts in a separate pilot at this time. On the other hand, MIP and community microgrid uptake overall has been slow. As such, VGIC believes that the resources and funding previously directed for use in V2X Microgrid Phase II should be used to cover MIP and community microgrid support, which is likely to remain minimal, *as well as supplementing existing staff support and funding for the more active and impactful Residential and Commercial V2X Pilots.*

II. PG&E AND OTHER UTILITIES SHOULD FILE DETAILS ON VENDORS CONFIDENTIALLY.

While VGIC is understanding of PG&E's request in the Advice Letter, it was inappropriate for PG&E to publish details on individual vendors in Appendix I in a public filing. Publicly revealing vendor names was unnecessary to provide the Energy Division staff with sufficient responses to data requests for useful context on pilot challenges. Publicly attributing specific technical or contractual difficulties to a single company risks reputational harm while offering little value to regulatory decision-making.

Typically, public filings such as Advice Letters describe vendor-related issues without disclosing specific names, which allows the Commission and stakeholders to understand the nature of the problem without singling out individual companies. Indeed, in the body of this Supplemental Advice Letter on page 3, PG&E appropriately summarized vendor and contractor challenges in general terms without naming companies. That level of detail was sufficient and should have been what was included in the public-facing document.

Moreover, PG&E itself acknowledges that these challenges were not the result of unique failures by any individual vendor but rather reflected broader issues with the nascency of the bidirectional charging market. As PG&E states: "If we are to expand this microgrid pilot and add more EVSE vendors and EV OEMs in different microgrid settings, it is a practical certainty that there will be similar problems of significant magnitude/impact, and the pilot will continue to

experience significant delays.”¹ This demonstrates that the problems encountered by PG&E in the deployment of the V2X Microgrid Pilot were industry-wide, not vendor-specific. Therefore, it was unnecessary to name individual vendors in the public filing.

VGIC understands that the details in Appendix I were provided in response to Energy Division questions, but PG&E should have filed that portion of the Advice Letter confidentially. The Commission has long-standing procedures to allow utilities to provide sensitive information under seal, ensuring regulators have full access without unnecessarily disclosing commercially sensitive details to the public. Moreover, utilities have long closely followed the norm of disclosing sensitive information confidentially, and the departure from that norm in this case is entirely unexpected and unnecessary.

By instead choosing to single out a vendor in a public filing, PG&E departed from regulatory norms and created the risk of chilling future participation from innovative companies who may be less willing to partner with utilities if early-stage challenges are likely to be publicized. This is particularly concerning given the relatively nascent market for bidirectional charging solutions and vendors, and the immense pressures already creating challenges for that market, including the uncertainty about how and when mass-market, cost-based compensation mechanisms will be made available to customers eager to adopt this technology. For these reasons, VGIC urges the Commission and Energy Division staff to remind PG&E and other utilities that vendor-specific information should be submitted confidentially in future Advice Letters.

III. CONCLUSION.

VGIC appreciates the opportunity to submit this response to the Advice Letter and looks forward to collaborating with the Energy Division and stakeholders on this important initiative.

Respectfully submitted,

/s/ Zach Woogen

Zach Woogen

Executive Director

Vehicle Grid Integration Council (VGIC)

cc: Sidney Bob Dietz II, PG&E, c/o Megan Lawson (PGETariffs@pge.com)
Service lists: R.18-12-006 and R.23-12-008

¹ Advice Letter at 4.